



**Leeds** School of Business  
UNIVERSITY OF COLORADO **BOULDER**

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**FNCE 4080: Blockchain and Cryptocurrencies –  
Speculation or Innovation?**

A course offering of the Leeds School's

**HERNANDO DE SOTO  
CAPITAL MARKETS PROGRAM**

**Spring 2024**

**Tu & Th 12:30-1:45 Koelbel 312**

**Instructor:** Eric Alston  
Scholar in Residence, Division of Finance  
Faculty Director, Hernando de Soto Capital Markets Program  
Koelbel 425J  
(303) 735-6874

**Office Hours:** Tuesday 2:00 – 3:00 PM  
Wednesday 11:00 AM – 12:00 PM  
and by appointment

**Email:** Eric.Alston@colorado.edu

## **Course Overview:**

The past few years have proven to be significant for digital currencies in terms of their salience to the public generally, but also to more sophisticated institutional investors. Meteoric increases (and drops!) in prices have led to institutional investors facing significant pressures from their clients to diversify into these risky, and hence potentially highly profitable, asset classes. This increased demand for involvement by sophisticated investors effectively demanded regulatory involvement on the part of US federal agencies that had already been scrutinizing the space. Despite the number of individuals purchasing and using digital currencies, and a correspondingly larger market capitalization, the typical investor's understanding of the underlying business models of different digital currencies is quite limited. While many investors recognize that blockchain technology gives digital currencies their desirable features, they do not understand the technology itself, let alone the ways that competing blockchains differ and what this means for the viability of the business model a given blockchain is intended to support. Moreover, general understanding of blockchain applications separate from cryptocurrency application is quite lacking, as evidenced by increases in stock prices for companies that simply added blockchain to their names.

In addition to blockchain and digital currencies, this course will introduce students to a variety of cutting-edge developments like smart contracts, DeFi, and DAOs; the current stance of federal (and international) regulators with respect to digital currencies; and some of the latest developments surrounding central bank digital currencies (CBDCs) and cross border payments. Given the market capitalization of digital currencies, and the rapidly increasing salience of blockchain applications more generally, a more rigorous grounding in cryptocurrencies and their underlying technology is of increasing importance for roles in the private sector.

This course is broken down into 7 topical modules (2-5 classes of treatment depending on topic):

- 1. Introduction & Opposing Perspectives on Cryptocurrencies**
- 2. What is Blockchain?**
- 3. What are Digital Currencies?**
- 4. What are Smart Contracts, deFi and DAOs?**
- MIDTERM**
- 5. How are Blockchains and Cryptocurrencies GOVERNED?**
- 6. Frauds and Hacks and Bubbles, Oh my!**
- 7. How are Cryptocurrencies REGULATED?**
- 8. Government and Bank Involvement**
- FINAL EXAM**

## **Required Readings:**

See the Tentative Course Outline below for readings due dates. To be successful in the class, students must keep up with the readings as they form a background for class interactions.

All course files are available through the CU library system's permissions or will be provided to you prior to the start of the topic. Remember that your Colorado.EDU email account is official CU communication. You must monitor that account for information from CU and your professors (for all your courses).

## **Course Requirements and Grading:**

|       |                                             |
|-------|---------------------------------------------|
| 20%   | Quizzes (Readings Recall and Comprehension) |
| 25%   | Midterm Exam                                |
| 30%   | Final Exam                                  |
| 15%   | Individual Participation and Attendance     |
| 6%    | Student Case Study                          |
| 4%    | Two discussion posts on Canvas              |
| 100 % | Total                                       |

**Quizzes (20%):** For nearly every topical module, students will be asked to recall pieces of the required readings for a grade on Canvas prior to approaching them in class. There will be eight such quizzes. Based upon past student performance on my reading quizzes, it is highly likely that these quizzes will be curved.

**Midterm and Final Exams (25% and 30% respectively):** There are two exam dates for this course. The first midterm represents 25% of the final course grade. The final exam represents 30% of your final grade and will take place at the University's posted final exam time.

**Individual Participation and Attendance (15%):** This class introduces students to a variety of challenging topics through class discussion and critical synthesis across scholars. Absent active participation in class discussion, the range of complex ideas addressed throughout the course will be much more difficult to assimilate. In addition to attendance taken randomly over the course of the semester, your individual participation is assessed based on responses to cold-calls, participation in class discussions, and your apparent level of preparation for, and participation in, class activities.

**Student Case Study (6%):** The presentation will entail the student finding a new topic relevant to the course module, summarizing the topic, and then explaining its relevance to the course concepts in roughly 6-8 minutes, with another 2-4 minutes of questions/discussion.

**Canvas Discussion Posts (4%):** Two reflection discussion posts on Canvas.

## Tentative Course Outline

| #  | Date            | Course Topic                 | Topic Class                                |                                                                                    |
|----|-----------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | 01/16           | Introduction                 | Syllabus review and participant intros     | No readings.                                                                       |
| 2  | 01/18<br>(QUIZ) | Introduction                 | Divergent Perspectives on Cryptocurrencies | Cowen, Dale, Juels & Prasad, Ma, Munger                                            |
| 3  | 01/23           | What is Blockchain?          | Distributed Ledger Technology              | Ghiro et al, Jeffries, Robitzski, IBM                                              |
| 4  | 01/25           | What is Blockchain?          | Distributed Ledger Technology              | Extended Discussion<br><b>Case Study Sign-up DUE</b><br><b>Discussion Post DUE</b> |
| 5  | 01/30<br>(QUIZ) | What is Blockchain?          | Consensus Methods                          | Aggarwal & Kumar, Ghiro et al, Rosenberg                                           |
| 6  | 02/01           | What are digital currencies? | Cryptos as Money                           | Grace Lee, Perkins, Shin                                                           |
| 7  | 02/06           | What are digital currencies? | Ethereum Guest Lecture                     | TBD                                                                                |
| 8  | 02/08           | What are digital currencies? | Gitcoin Guest Lecture                      | TBD                                                                                |
| 9  | 02/13           | What are digital currencies? | Cryptos Applied                            | Nakamoto, Buterin, Khallili, Lieber, Singh & Mattackal                             |
| 10 | 02/15           | What are digital currencies? | What's in a token?                         | Canovas del Castillo, Lee Malone & Wong, Shiflett and Jones (x2)                   |
| 11 | 02/20<br>(QUIZ) | What are digital currencies? | Stablecoins                                | Asgari & Chipolina; Baughman, Carapella, Gerszten, and Mills; Calomiris; Schwartz  |
| 12 | 02/22           | What are digital currencies? | STUDENT CASE STUDIES                       | No readings assigned                                                               |
| 13 | 02/27           | Smart Contracts, deFi, DAOs  | Smart Contracts                            | Arruñada, Ethereum, Levi and Lipton, IBM                                           |
| 14 | 02/29           | Smart Contracts, deFi, DAOs  | deFi                                       | Makridis, Frowis, Sridhar, and Bohme; Ronis; Schär (x2)                            |
| 15 | 03/05<br>(QUIZ) | Smart Contracts, deFi, DAOs  | DAOs                                       | Ethereum, Patel, Roose, Wright                                                     |
| 16 | 03/07           | Smart Contracts, deFi, DAOs  | Discussion and Review                      | No readings assigned                                                               |
| 17 | 03/12           | <b>MIDTERM</b>               | <b>MIDTERM</b>                             | All readings assigned                                                              |

|    |                 |                                                   |                                         |                                                                                                    |
|----|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 18 | 03/14           | How are Blockchains & Cryptocurrencies GOVERNED?  | Polycentric & Constitutional Governance | Alston (2020); Alston, Law, Murtazashvili, and Weiss (2021)                                        |
| 19 | 03/19 (QUIZ)    | How are Blockchains & Cryptocurrencies GOVERNED?  | Competitive Governance                  | Alston; Alston, Law, Murtazashvili, and Weiss (2021); Alston, Law, Murtazashvili, and Weiss (2022) |
| 20 | 03/21 (XC QUIZ) | How are Blockchains & Cryptocurrencies GOVERNED?  | Ethics as Governance                    | Primer, Bagus & de la Horra, Blackman, Bruno, Economist                                            |
| 21 | 04/02           | Frauds and Hacks and Bubbles                      | Mt. Gox, DAO hack                       | McMillan, Pollack, Finley, Leising                                                                 |
| 22 | 04/04 (QUIZ)    | Frauds and Hacks and Bubbles                      | Terra/Luna, FTX                         | Liu, Schoar and Makarov; Economist; Stewart; White; Yaffe-Bellany & Griffith                       |
| 22 | 04/09           | Frauds and Hacks and Bubbles                      | STUDENT CASE STUDIES                    | No readings assigned                                                                               |
| 23 | 04/11           | How are Blockchains & Cryptocurrencies REGULATED? | United States                           | Crenshaw, Gensler, Palma, Peirce, Scaggs                                                           |
| 25 | 04/16 (QUIZ)    | How are Blockchains & Cryptocurrencies REGULATED? | Global                                  | Adrian, Alston (2023), Atlantic Council, FSB(x2)                                                   |
| 26 | 04/18           | Central Banks, Govts, Borders                     | CBDC: US                                | Emmer, Michel & Anthony, Federal Reserve, Rogoff                                                   |
| 27 | 04/23           | Central Banks, Govts, Borders                     | CBDC: Global                            | Buiter, Atlantic Council, Eichengreen, Nagy Mohácsi                                                |
| 28 | 04/25           | Central Banks, Govts, Borders                     | Disrupted? Improved?                    | Digital Banker, Schreckinger, Tapscott                                                             |
| 29 | 04/30 (QUIZ)    | Central Banks, Govts, Borders                     | Brave new world...?                     | Bastardo, NBER, Garratt & Hong Shin, Montagner                                                     |
| 30 | 05/02           | Conclusion & Review                               | Wrap-up                                 | No readings assigned<br><b>Discussion Post DUE</b>                                                 |
|    | TBD             | <b>Final Exam</b>                                 | TBD                                     | Who doesn't like a good final exam?                                                                |

## **Detailed Reading List:**

### **1. Introduction & Divergent Perspectives on Cryptocurrencies**

#### **A. Syllabus Review & Participant Intros**

#### **B. Divergent Perspectives**

Cowen, T. "[The resurgence of crypto.](#)" Marginal Revolution. Dec. 9, 2023.

Dale, B. "[From NFTs to XRP: the biggest crypto stories of 2023.](#)" Axios. Dec. 20, 2023.

Juels, A., and E. Prasad. "[Whither Crypto?](#)" Project Syndicate. Nov. 15, 2023.

Ma, A. "[The crypto comeback.](#)" NPR.org. Dec. 30, 2023.

Munger, C. "[Why America Should Ban Crypto.](#)" WSJ.com. Feb. 1, 2023.

"[Why Bitcoin is up by almost 150% this year.](#)" Economist.com. Dec. 18, 2023.

### **2. What is Blockchain?**

#### **A. Distributed Ledger Technology**

Ghiro, L. et al. "[What is a Blockchain? A Definition to Clarify the Role of the Blockchain in the Internet of Things.](#)" arXiv preprint arXiv:2102.03750. 2021. "**Sections 1; 2 'Blockchain Fundamentals'; 2.1**"

Jeffries, A. "['Blockchain' is Meaningless.](#)" The Verge. Mar. 7, 2018.

Robitzski, D. "[Scientists Say Blockchains 'Fit Some Definitions of Life'.](#)" Futurism.com. Aug. 10, 2021.

"[What is Blockchain?](#)". IBM.com. "**Blockchain Overview; Blockchain 101 in five minutes; Types of Blockchain Networks.**"

#### **B. Discuss**

#### **C. Consensus Algorithms**

Aggarwal, S., and N. Kumar. "[Cryptographic consensus mechanisms.](#)" In *Advances in Computers*, vol. 121. Elsevier, 2021. **Pp. 212-214.**

Ghiro, L. et al. "[What is a Blockchain? A Definition to Clarify the Role of the Blockchain in the Internet of Things.](#)" arXiv preprint arXiv:2102.03750, 2021. "**3.2; 3.3.2; 4.1; 4.2**".

Rosenberg, E. "[What is a Consensus Mechanism?](#)" TheBalance.com. Dec. 1, 2021.

### **3. What are Digital Currencies?**

#### **A. Cryptocurrencies In the History of Money**

Grace Lee, A. "[The History of Cryptocurrency: Bitcoin's Long, Strange Trip to Best-Performing Asset of the Decade.](#)" Esquire. May 12, 2021.

Perkins, D. "[Cryptocurrency: The Economics of Money and Selected Policy Issues.](#)"

Congressional Research Service. Apr. 9, 2020. **Pp. 1-19.**

Shin, H.S. "[Cryptocurrencies: looking beyond the hype.](#)" BIS.org. June 17, 2018. **Pp. 91-94.**

#### **B. Developer Guest Lecture (Ethereum)**

#### **C. Developer Guest Lecture (Bitcoin)**

#### **D. Cryptocurrencies Applied**

Nakamoto, S. "[Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System.](#)" White Paper (2008).

Buterin, V. "A next-generation smart contract and decentralized application platform." White Paper (2014). **Pp. 1; 4; 34.**

Khallili, J. "The Not-So-Subtle Art of the Meme Coin." Wired. May 23, 2023.

Lieber, R. "Letter to a Young Crypto Enthusiast (or the Merely Curious)." NYTimes.com. Aug. 15, 2023.

Singh, M., and L.P. Mattackal. "Cryptoverse: Bitcoin defies its doubters in 2023." Reuters. Dec. 14, 2023.

#### **E. What's in a Token?**

Canovas del Castillo, J.R. "Evolution of Non-Fungible Tokens." WEF. Oct. 2023. **Pp. 4-10.**

Lee, A., B. Malone and P. Wong. "Tokens and accounts in the context of digital currencies." FEDS Notes. Dec. 23, 2020. "**Introduction**" through "**Other types of crypto tokens**"

Shifflett, S. and C. Jones. "A Flood of Questionable Cryptocurrency Offerings." The Wall Street Journal. Jan. 9, 2019.

Shifflett, S. and C. Jones. "Buyer Beware: Hundreds of Bitcoin Wannabes Show Hallmarks of Fraud." The Wall Street Journal. May 17, 2018.

Optional: Alston, E. "When Digital Carnival? – Distributed Control of the Metaverse Asset Layer to Enable Creative Digital Expression to Flourish" in Dupont, Q., Dylan-Ennis, P. and Kavanagh, D., eds. *Cryptocarnival*. Off-Chain Collective: 2023.

Optional: Rockett, C. "The real disruption is coming." Boulder Weekly. Mar. 11, 2021.

#### **F. Stablecoins**

Asgari, N., and S. Chipolina. "Stablecoin operator Circle files for second attempt at IPO." FT.com. Jan. 11, 2024.

Baughman, G., F. Carapella, J. Gerszten, and D. Mills. "The stable in stablecoins." FEDS Notes. Dec. 16, 2022.

Calomiris, C. "Will Fractional-Reserve Stablecoin Banking Replace Bitcoin and Some Traditional Banking Payments?" *Journal of Applied Corporate Finance* 33, no. 4 (2021): 70-75.

Schwartz, L. "Coinbase is playing a 'dangerous game' against the SEC with its stablecoin USDC." Fortune. Jan. 3, 2024.

Optional: Adachi, M. et al. "Stablecoins' role in crypto and beyond: functions, risks and policy." ECB.eu. July 2022.

#### **G. STUDENT CASE STUDIES**

### **4. What are Smart Contracts, deFi, and DAOs?**

#### **A. Smart Contracts**

Arruñada, B. "Blockchain's Struggle to Deliver Impersonal Exchange." 19 Minn. J.L. Sci. & Tech. 55 (2018). **Pp 58-81.**

"Introduction to Smart Contracts." Ethereum.org. Dec. 22, 2021.

Levi, S. D., & Lipton, A. B. (2018). An Introduction to Smart Contracts and Their Potential and Inherent Limitations. Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance.

"What are smart contracts on blockchain?" IBM.org.

#### **B. DeFi**

Asgari, N. and S. Chipolina. "Bitcoin's Wall Street takeover frustrates crypto's true believers." FT.com. Jan. 12, 2024.

Makridis, C.A., M. Frowis, K. Sridhar, and R. Bohme. "The rise of decentralized cryptocurrency exchanges: Evaluating the role of airdrops and governance tokens." *Journal of Corporate Finance*. Apr. 2023. **Introduction.**

Ronis, J. "From Delphi to DeFi: How Crypto Oracles are Shaping the Future of Finance." Wilson Center. Oct. 20, 2023.

Schär, F. "Decentralized finance: On blockchain-and smart contract-based financial markets." *FRB of St. Louis Review* (2021).

Schär, F. "DeFi's Promise and Pitfalls." IMF.org. Sept. 2022.

### C. DAOs

"Decentralized Autonomous Organizations." Ethereum.org. Jan. 5, 2022.

Patel, N. "From a Meme to \$47 Million: ConstitutionDAO, Crypto, and the Future of Crowdfunding." *The Verge*. Dec. 7, 2021. **(Podcast OR Transcript).**

Roose, K. "What are DAOs?" *NYTimes.com*. Mar. 18, 2022.

Wright, A. "The Rise of Decentralized Autonomous Organizations: Opportunities and Challenges." *Stanford Journal of Blockchain Law and Policy*. 2021. **(Sections I - Introduction; and II - Decentralized Autonomous Organizations and Their Potential Advantages).**

Optional: Appel, I., and J. Grennan. "Control of Decentralized Autonomous Organizations." *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, May 2023.

### D. Discussion and Review

### E. **MIDTERM (03/12)**

## 5. How are Cryptocurrencies GOVERNED?

### A. Polycentric & Constitutional Governance

Alston, E., W. Law, I. Murtazashvili, and M. Weiss. "Can Permissionless Blockchains Avoid Governance and the Law?". *Notre Dame Journal of Emerging Technologies*. 2: 2021.

**Introduction, Section III, Section IV, Conclusion.**

Alston, E. "Constitutions and Blockchains: Competitive Governance of Fundamental Rule Sets." *Case Western Journal of Law, Technology and the Internet*. 2020. **SKIM Section 3.A and 3.B.**

### B. Competitive Governance

Alston, E. "Constitutions and Blockchains: Competitive Governance of Fundamental Rule Sets." *Case Western Journal of Law, Technology and the Internet*. 2020. **SKIM Section 3.C.**

Alston, Eric, Wilson Law, Ilia Murtazashvili, and Martin B. Weiss. "Can Permissionless Blockchains Avoid Governance and the Law?". *Notre Dame Journal of Emerging Technologies*. 2: 2021. **Section V.**

Alston, Eric, Wilson Law, Ilia Murtazashvili, and Martin B. Weiss. "Blockchain Networks as Constitutional and Competitive Polycentric Orders." *Journal of Institutional Economics*. 2022. **Pp. 15-18; 23-29.**

### C. Ethics as Governance

"A Primer of Major Ethical Theories."

Bagus, P. and de la Horra, L.P., 2021. "An ethical defense of cryptocurrencies." *Business Ethics, the Environment & Responsibility*, 30(3), pp.423-431.



Blackman, R. “Why Blockchain’s Ethical Stakes Are So High.” Harvard Business Review. May 10, 2022.

Bruno. “The Anatomy of a Pump & Dump Group.” Bitfalls.com. Dec. 1, 2018.

“Does Islam smile on cryptocurrency?” Economist.com. July 23, 2023.

## **6. Frauds and Hacks and Bubbles, Oh my!**

### **A. Mt. Gox & The DAO Hack:**

McMillan, Robert. “The Inside Story of Mt. Gox, Bitcoin’s \$460 Million Disaster.” Wired. Mar. 3<sup>rd</sup>, 2014.

Pollock, Darryn. “The Mess That Was Mt. Gox: Four Years On.” Coin Telegraph. Mar. 9, 2018.

Finley, Klint. “A \$50 Million Hack Just Showed That the DAO Was All Too Human.” Wired. June 18, 2016.

Leising, Matthew. “The Ether Thief.” Bloomberg. June 13, 2017.

### **B. Terra/Luna & FTX**

Liu, J., A. Schoar, and I. Makarov. “Anatomy of a Run: The Terra Luna Crash.” Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance. May 22, 2023.

“Sam Bankman Fried’s downfall is complete.” Economist.com. Nov. 3, 2023.

Stewart, E. “Crypto: New. Fraud: Old.” Vox.com. May 18, 2023.

White, M. “Sam Bankman-Fried and the People Who Gave Up Their Money for Nothing.” NYTimes.com. Nov. 8, 2023.

Yaffe-Bellany, D. and E. Griffith. “How a Trash-Talking Crypto Founder Caused a \$40 Billion Crash.” NYTimes.com. May 18, 2022.

Optional: Briola, A., D. Vidal-Tomás, Y. Wang, and T. Aste. “Anatomy of a Stablecoin’s failure: The Terra-Luna case.” Finance Research Letters. Jan. 2023. **Abstract**.

Optional: Scott, H. and J. Gulliver “A Question for Congress: Why Didn’t the SEC Stop FTX?” WSJ.com. Jan. 18, 2023.

### **C. STUDENT CASE STUDIES**

## **7. How are digital currencies REGULATED?**

### **A. United States Regulation:**

Crenshaw, C.A. “Statement Dissenting from Approval of Proposed Rule Changes to List and Trade Spot Bitcoin Exchange-Traded Products.” SEC.gov. Jan. 10, 2024. **Section II only**.

Gensler, G. “Statement on the Approval of Spot Bitcoin Exchange-Traded Products.” SEC.gov. Jan. 10, 2024.

Palma, S. “SEC’s bitcoin ETF sign-off comes with a stark reminder of its lingering doubts.” FT.com. Jan. 11, 2024.

Peirce, H. “Out, Damned Spot! Out, I Say![1]: Statement on Omnibus Approval Order for List and Trade Bitcoin-Based Commodity-Based Trust Shares and Trust Units.” SEC.gov. Jan. 10, 2024.

Scaggs, A. “Talk to your kids about their spot bitcoin ETF use.” FT.com. Jan. 11, 2024.

### **B. Global Regulation:**

Adrian, T. “Crypto Needs Comprehensive Policies to Protect Economies and Investors.” IMF.org. July 18, 2023.

Alston, E. “Digital Currency Industry Self-Regulation: Not All Consensus is Automatic.” *Virginia Journal of Law and Technology*. Vol. 27: 2023., **Sections III, IV, and V.**  
 “Cryptocurrency Regulation Tracker.” Atlantic Council. **Introductory text & Key Findings.**  
 “High-level Recommendations for the Regulation, Supervision and Oversight of Crypto-asset Activities and Markets: Final report.” Financial Stability Board. July 17, 2023.  
 “High-level Recommendations for the Regulation, Supervision and Oversight of Global Stablecoin Arrangements: Final report.” Financial Stability Board. July 17, 2023.  
 Optional (treated in lecture): Alston, E. “Blockchain and the Law: Legality, Law-like Characteristics, and Legal Applications,” in Caton, J, ed. *Economics of Blockchain and Cryptocurrency: A Transaction Costs Revolution*. Edward Elgar. 2022.

## **8. Central Banks, Governments, and Borders**

### **A. Central Bank Digital Currencies: US**

“Emmer’s CBDC Anti-Surveillance State Act Passes Financial Services Committee.” Office of House Representative Tom Emmer Press Release. Sept. 20, 2023.  
 Michel, N. and N. Anthony. “The Risks of CBDCs.” Cato.org. Feb. 22, 2023.  
 “Money and Payments: The U.S. Dollar in the Age of Digital Transformation.” Federal Reserve. Jan. 2022. **SKIM pp. 1-9. READ pp. 13-20.**  
 Rogoff, K. “The Fed’s Wary Embrace of Digital Dollars.” Project Syndicate. Feb. 1, 2022.

### **B. Central Bank Digital Currencies: Global**

Buiter, W.H. “A Farewell to Cash.” Project Syndicate. Dec. 11, 2023.  
 “Central Bank Digital Currency Tracker.” Atlantic Council. June 2023.  
 Eichengreen, B. “The Trilemma of Central Bank Digital Currencies.” Project Syndicate. Nov. 9, 2022.  
 Nagy Mohácsi, P. “The Digital Economy’s New Monetary Imperative.” Project Syndicate. June 2, 2023.  
 Yates, T. “Why central banks should not push ahead with CBDCs.” FT.com. Jan. 15, 2023.

### **C. Payments, Governments, Borders - Disrupted? Improved?**

“A digital dollar is for banks and governments, but not you.” Digital Banker. Aug. 7, 2023.  
 Schreckinger, B. “Crypto’s winners and losers after a bank run.” Politico.com. Mar. 16, 2023.  
 Tapscott, Bob. “Reinventing International Clearing and Settlement.” in Tapscott, Alex. *Financial Services Revolution*. Barlow Publishing: 2020. **Pp. 188-208; 221-224.**

### **D. Brave New World...?**

Bastardo, J. “Regulatory Ease And Dollar Access To Accelerate Bitcoin Adoption In Milei’s Argentina.” Forbes. Dec. 3, 2023.  
 “El Salvador’s Experiment with Bitcoin as Legal Tender.” NBER Digest. July 2022.  
 Garratt, R. and H. Song Shin. “Stablecoins versus tokenised deposits: implications for the singleness of money.” BIS.org. Apr. 11, 2023. Pp. 1-6.  
 Montagner, D. “Stablecoins gain momentum in Argentina as peso plummets.” The Banker. Oct. 31, 2023.

### **E. REVIEW**

## **Required CU Syllabus Policy Statements**

### **Classroom Behavior**

Students and faculty are responsible for maintaining an appropriate learning environment in all instructional settings, whether in person, remote, or online. Failure to adhere to such behavioral standards may be subject to discipline. Professional courtesy and sensitivity are especially important with respect to individuals and topics dealing with race, color, national origin, sex, pregnancy, age, disability, creed, religion, sexual orientation, gender identity, gender expression, veteran status, political affiliation, or political philosophy.

For more information, see the [classroom behavior policy](#), the [Student Code of Conduct](#), and the [Office of Institutional Equity and Compliance](#).

### **Requirements for Infectious Disease**

Members of the CU Boulder community and visitors to campus must follow university, department, and building health and safety requirements and all applicable campus policies and public health guidelines to reduce the risk of spreading infectious diseases. If public health conditions require, the university may also invoke related requirements for student conduct and disability accommodation that will apply to this class.

If you feel ill and think you might have COVID-19 or if you have tested positive for COVID-19, please stay home and follow the [guidance of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention \(CDC\) for isolation and testing](#). If you have been in close contact with someone who has COVID-19 but do not have any symptoms and have not tested positive for COVID-19, you do not need to stay home but should follow the [guidance of the CDC for masking and testing](#).

### **Accommodation for Disabilities, Temporary Medical Conditions, and Medical Isolation**

If you qualify for accommodations because of a disability, please submit your accommodation letter from Disability Services to your faculty member in a timely manner so that your needs can be addressed. Disability Services determines accommodations based on documented disabilities in the academic environment. Information on requesting accommodations is located on the [Disability Services website](#). Contact Disability Services at 303-492-8671 or [dsinfo@colorado.edu](mailto:dsinfo@colorado.edu) for further assistance. If you have a temporary medical condition, see [Temporary Medical Conditions](#) on the Disability Services website.

If you have a required medical isolation for which you require adjustment, please contact your instructor as soon as you become aware of the need.

### **Preferred Student Names and Pronouns**

CU Boulder recognizes that students' legal information doesn't always align with how they identify. Students may update their preferred names and pronouns via the student portal; those preferred names and pronouns are listed on instructors' class rosters. In the absence of such updates, the name that appears on the class roster is the student's legal name.

### **Honor Code**

All students enrolled in a University of Colorado Boulder course are responsible for knowing and adhering to the [Honor Code](#). Violations of the Honor Code may include but are not limited to: plagiarism (including use of paper writing services or technology [such as essay bots]), cheating, fabrication, lying, bribery, threat, unauthorized access to academic materials, clicker fraud, submitting the same or similar work in more than one course without permission from all course instructors involved, and aiding academic dishonesty.

All incidents of academic misconduct will be reported to Student Conduct & Conflict Resolution: [honor@colorado.edu](mailto:honor@colorado.edu), 303-492-5550. Students found responsible for violating the [Honor Code](#) will be assigned resolution outcomes from the Student Conduct & Conflict Resolution as well as be subject to academic sanctions from the faculty member. Visit [Honor Code](#) for more information on the academic integrity policy.

### **Sexual Misconduct, Discrimination, Harassment and/or Related Retaliation**

CU Boulder is committed to fostering an inclusive and welcoming learning, working, and living environment. University policy prohibits [protected-class](#) discrimination and harassment, sexual misconduct (harassment, exploitation, and assault), intimate partner violence (dating or domestic violence), stalking, and related retaliation by or against members of our community on- and off-campus. These behaviors harm individuals and our community. The Office of Institutional Equity and Compliance (OIEC) addresses these concerns, and individuals who have been subjected to misconduct can contact OIEC at 303-492-2127 or email [cureport@colorado.edu](mailto:cureport@colorado.edu). Information about university policies, [reporting options](#), and [support resources](#) can be found on the [OIEC website](#).

Please know that faculty and graduate instructors must inform OIEC when they are made aware of incidents related to these policies regardless of when or where something occurred. This is to ensure that individuals impacted receive

outreach from OIEC about resolution options and support resources. To learn more about reporting and support for a variety of concerns, visit the [Don't Ignore It](#) page.

#### Religious Accommodations

Campus policy requires faculty to provide reasonable accommodations for students who, because of religious obligations, have conflicts with scheduled exams, assignments or required attendance. Please communicate the need for a religious accommodation in a timely manner. In this class, please notify your instructor at the beginning of the semester of any religious accommodations that you anticipate.

See the [campus policy regarding religious observances](#) for full details.

#### Mental Health and Wellness

The University of Colorado Boulder is committed to the well-being of all students. If you are struggling with personal stressors, mental health or substance use concerns that are impacting academic or daily life, please contact [Counseling and Psychiatric Services \(CAPS\)](#) located in C4C or call (303) 492-2277, 24/7.

Free and unlimited telehealth is also available through [Academic Live Care](#). The [Academic Live Care](#) site also provides information about additional wellness services on campus that are available to students.